

# Carlos César Chávez Padilla

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*Development economist working on human capital and political economy, combining structural estimation with high-frequency data. Research Professional with James J. Heckman at the University of Chicago, and builder of Qhawarina, a real-time open-data platform for Peru.*

## Education

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| <b>University of Chicago, Harris School of Public Policy</b><br>Master of Arts in Public Policy. <i>Merit Scholarship.</i>                 | 2024–2025 |
| <b>Universidad Nacional Mayor de San Marcos (UNMSM)</b><br>B.A. in Economics, with honors (GPA 3.9/4.0). <i>Best Undergraduate Thesis.</i> | 2013–2017 |
| <b>Universidad Nacional de Ingeniería</b><br>Diplomas in Applied Econometrics and Finance.                                                 | 2018      |

## Research Interests

**Primary:** Development Economics; Early Childhood Development.    **Secondary:** Political Economy; Labor Economics.

## Research Experience

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| <b>Research Professional</b> , Center for the Economics of Human Development, U. of Chicago                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | 2024–present |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Work with Prof. James J. Heckman on early childhood skill formation and economic preferences.</li><li>Research on how cognitive skills and personality traits relate to economic preferences in Chinese children, using structural modeling (CRRA and Expo-Power utilities).</li></ul> |              |
| <b>Research Assistant</b> , Harris School of Public Policy, U. of Chicago                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | 2024–present |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>With Prof. Christopher Blattman on gang recruitment in Colombia; with Prof. Martin Castillo-Quintana on game-theoretic models of extortion.</li></ul>                                                                                                                                  |              |
| <b>Pre-Doctoral Fellow</b> , Georgetown University, McDonough School of Business                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | 2023–2024    |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>With Prof. Amory Gethin on the political economy of social movements; built ML/NLP pipelines (DeBERTa transformers) on U.S. congressional records.</li></ul>                                                                                                                           |              |
| <b>Research Analyst / Assistant</b> , International Monetary Fund (MCM Department)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | 2020–2023    |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Co-authored an IMF Working Paper on ethnic gaps and growth in Peru; research on political instability and macro outcomes across 180+ countries; supported country missions.</li></ul>                                                                                                  |              |
| <b>Earlier:</b> Research Consultant, Inter-American Development Bank (2019–2020); Research Assistant, Universidad del Pacífico (2018–2019).                                                                                                                                                                                  |              |

## Selected Research

- Relating Cognitive Skills and Personality Traits to Economic Preferences: A Study of Chinese Children** (with S. Feng, J.J. Heckman, Z. Yang). *R&R, Journal of Labor Economics*.
- Innovation, Liberalization, and Competition.** *Forthcoming, Journal of Business*.
- Commodity Booms and Violent Conflict.** *Under review, American Journal of Political Science*.
- Electoral Pressure and Political Lying.** *Under review, World Politics*.
- Import Liberalization, Not Export Expansion.** *Under review, Journal of International Economics*.

- **Fraud Allegations as Identification: A Within-Election Forensic Test.** *Under review, Political Analysis.*
- **The Anatomy of a Nobel Prize.** *Under review, Empirical Economics.*

## Other Working Papers

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- **Automation Is Not a Sufficient Statistic: Robots, AI, and Inequality.**
- **The Macroeconomic Consequences of Political Instability** (coups and TFP; Bjørnskov–Rode panel).
- **Missing Mass and Minimum Wages** (bunching estimator, Peru).
- **Identifying Monetary Policy Shocks in an Administered-Rate Economy: Evidence from Peru.**
- **The Shining Path of Violence: Long-term Effects on Human Capital in Peru.**
- **Spatial Sorting and Conflict Migration.**

## Publications

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- Chávez, C. (2024). Minimum Wage and Ethnic Gaps: Who are the Winners? *Journal of Economics, Race, and Policy*, 7(2), 93–121.
- Chávez, C. (2023). The Effects of Mining Presence on Inequality, Labor Income, and Poverty: Evidence from Peru. *Mineral Economics*, 36(4), 615–642.
- Chávez, C. (2023). Domestic Violence, Labor Market, and Minimum Wage: Theory and Evidence. *Review of Economics*, 74(3), 195–233.
- Chávez, C. (2020). The Impact of the El Niño Phenomenon on Dry-Forest-Dependent Communities' Welfare in Northern Peru. *Ecological Economics*.
- Chávez, C. (2024). Estimating the Effects of Financial Liberalisation on Governability and Social Stability. *Foreign Trade Review*, 59(4), 588–614.
- Chávez, C. (2024). Latin American Firm Cooperation Payoff Evidence. *The International Trade Journal*.
- Chávez, C., Salinas, G., & Yuri, Z. (2022). Closing Peru's Ethnic Gaps Amidst Sustained Economic Growth. *IMF Working Paper* 2022/180.

*Full list at Google Scholar.*

## Honors, Conferences & Teaching

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**Honors:** Merit Scholarship, U. of Chicago (2024); GSAS Future Leader Fellowship, Tufts (2023); Best Undergraduate Thesis, UNMSM (2017).

**Conference presentations:** Jinan University, Guangzhou (2026, with Feng, Heckman, Yang); Institute for Fiscal Studies, London (2026); Encuentro de Economistas, UNMSM, Lima (2026); IEA World Congress, Medellín (2023); LACEA–LAMES, Lima (2022); Bolivian Conference on Development Economics, La Paz (2022); Annual Conference of Peruvian Economists, Lima (2021–2022).

**Teaching:** Instructor, Universidad Nacional de Ingeniería — Econometric Theory, Econometrics I (2020–2022); TA, UNMSM — Microeconomics, Macroeconomics (2015–2018).

## Skills & Affiliations

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**Programming:** Stata, R (advanced); Python, Matlab (proficient).    **Methods:** structural estimation, panel data econometrics, causal inference, instrumental variables, machine learning, NLP.    **Languages:** Spanish (native), English (fluent).    **Member:** AEA, Royal Economic Society, Econometric Society.

## References

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**James J. Heckman** — Henry Schultz Distinguished Service Professor, U. of Chicago, [jjh@uchicago.edu](mailto:jjh@uchicago.edu).  
**Amory Gethin** — Economist, Development Research Group, World Bank, [agethin@worldbank.org](mailto:agethin@worldbank.org).  
**Vincent Pons** — Byron Wien Professor, Harvard Business School, [vpons@hbs.edu](mailto:vpons@hbs.edu).